

Probosciger aterrimus

Palm cockatoo



Length 23½ in (60 cm)
Weight 2¼ lb (1 kg)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location New Guinea, N.E. Australia



The largest of about 18 species of cockatoos, the palm cockatoo is also distinguished by its entirely black plumage, huge, hooked bill with which it can crack open palm nuts and other hard-shelled seeds, and a piercing, whistle-like call. When excited or alarmed, the palm cockatoo raises its striking crest of backward-curving, narrow feathers, and its prominent, bare crimson cheek patches deepen in color, causing it to “blush.”



Cacatua galerita

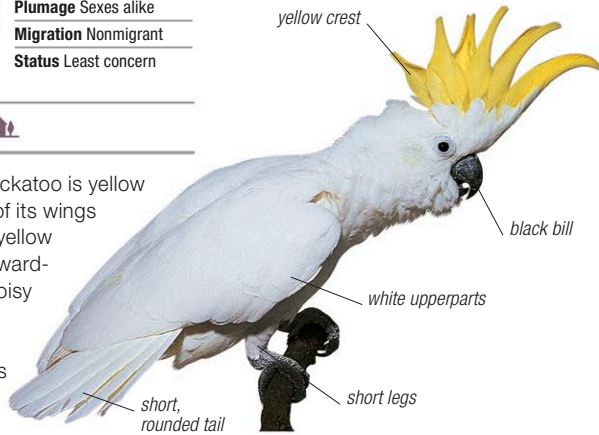
Sulphur-crested cockatoo



Length 20 in (50 cm)
Weight 34 oz (950 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location New Guinea, Australia (including Tasmania)

This large, white cockatoo is yellow on the undersides of its wings and tail, and has a yellow crest of narrow, forward-curving feathers. Noisy and active in the morning and late afternoon, it forages in flocks that vary in size from a few



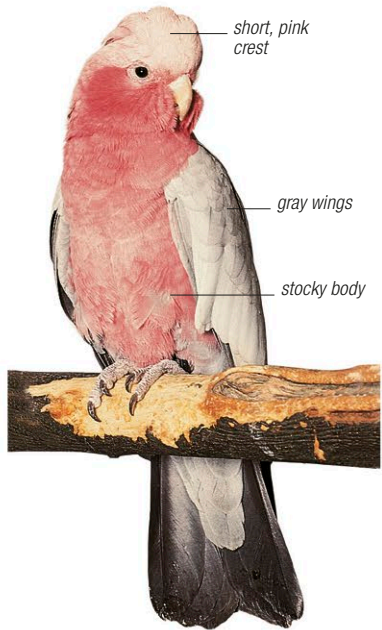
Eolophus roseicapillus

Galah



Length 14 in (35 cm)
Weight 12 oz (325 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location Australia (including Tasmania)



The most widespread and numerous species of cockatoo, the galah is a familiar sight throughout Australia. Flocks of these noisy and gregarious birds are found in arid scrubland as well as in city parks. Farming has increased this parrot's food supply, leading to a steady rise in population. The galah has a relatively small crest, and its gray back and pink underparts create an alternating effect as it veers through the air.

dozen birds to several hundred. At night, flocks occupy regularly used roosts, often in trees bordering water courses. This species is very popular as a pet, and both adults and chicks are regularly captured for the live-bird trade, a fact that poses a threat to the survival of some populations.

Nymphicus hollandicus

Cockatiel

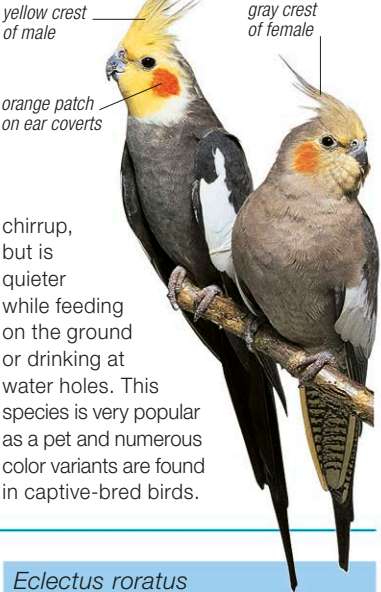


Length 12½ in (32 cm)
Weight 3¼ oz (90 g)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nomadic
Status Least concern

Location Australia



The cockatiel is the smallest species of cockatoo and the only one to have a long, pointed tail. The tapering crest is lowered when the bird is resting, or sometimes while feeding. In flight, the cockatiel emits a distinctive warbled



chirrup, but is quieter while feeding on the ground or drinking at water holes. This species is very popular as a pet and numerous color variants are found in captive-bred birds.

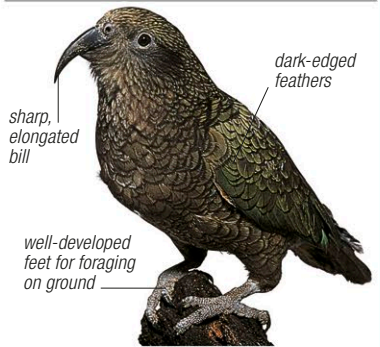
Nestor notabilis

Kea



Length 19 in (48 cm)
Weight 29 oz (825 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Vulnerable

Location New Zealand (South Island)



This large, stocky mountain bird is remarkable among parrots for its insatiable curiosity and wide-ranging diet. A natural opportunist, it will examine anything that appears to be edible, and often feeds on carrion, tearing it up with its unusually long bill, which resembles that of a bird of prey. Adults are largely olive-green, with orange underwings.

Eclectus roratus

Eclectus parrot

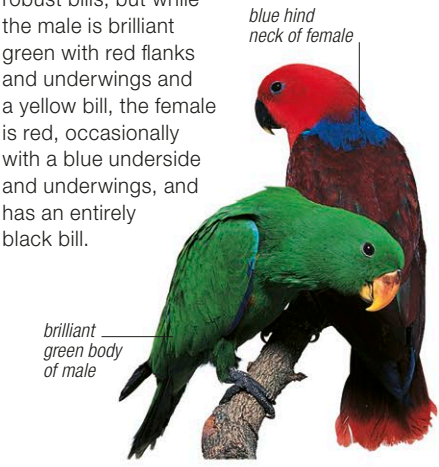


Length 14 in (35 cm)
Weight 18 oz (500 g)
Plumage Sexes differ
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location S.E. Asia, New Guinea, N.E. Australia, S.W. Pacific islands



The male and female eclectus parrots look so different from each other that early naturalists identified them as separate species. Both sexes are large and stocky, with squarish tails and robust bills, but while the male is brilliant green with red flanks and underwings and a yellow bill, the female is red, occasionally with a blue underside and underwings, and has an entirely black bill.



Platycercus elegans

Crimson rosella



Length 14 in (36 cm)
Weight 5 oz (150 g)
Plumage Sexes alike
Migration Nonmigrant
Status Least concern

Location E. and S.E. Australia



This is one of 6 species of rosellas, all of which have similar streamlined bodies and long tails, and are restricted to Australia and its outlying islands.



As its name suggests, the crimson rosella's plumage is red. It has violet-blue cheek patches and outer wing coverts, and a dark blue tail; the back and wings are mottled red and black. The bird tends to become quite tame around farms or in gardens. It has an undulating flight, dropping down toward the ground, gliding upward, and then landing.